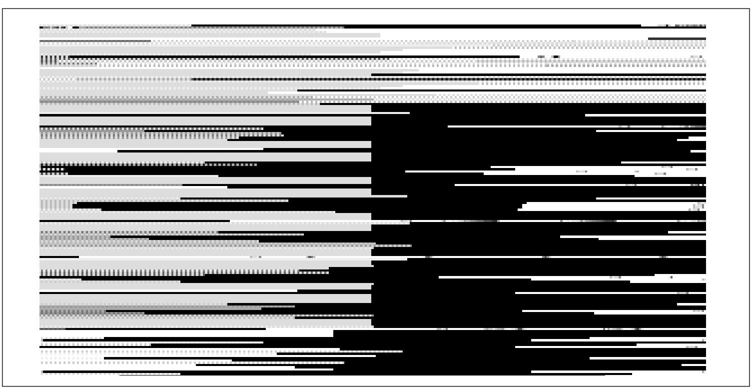
tings, which could potentially bring the whole network down. By contrast, Windows was intended for a PC, and any changes made on the PC would mostly affect the individual user rather than the network (unless it's run as a server, of course). That's why there's no strict user hierarchy, as compared to Linux.

A security feature of UNIX and hence Linux is that even programs run by a user cannot make critical changes to the system. This is one of the reasons for the fewer number of viruses affecting Linux machines. Only when a program is run from the root account does it have the permission to make any system changes. Thus, the responsibility for system security rests with the root user all the more. Thankfully, Unix and Linux system administrators are a smart lot!

2.4 The Linux Directory Structure

All operating systems have a directory structure in which system files are stored. User files will also be stored in a directory created by the OS itself unless otherwise specified. Of course, the user can create his own directories, but those do not constitute the system's directory structure. The following directories are commonly found in Linux:

The basic directory is the "/" directory—simply called the slash. This contains other directories used for various system purposes.



The directories created by Fedora during install